



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Bring that issue to the board meeting!



Learning Outcome

Express duty, advice, willingness, or intention to do something in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you enjoy attending formal meetings? Why or why not?
- What formal meetings have you attended?
- What was discussed at these meetings?

Can Do Statements

- I can discuss reasons for and results of an event or an action related to work and job.
- I can emphasize intentions or requirements related to job issues.
- I can present and respond to complex lines of argument in job situations.





Let's Explore!

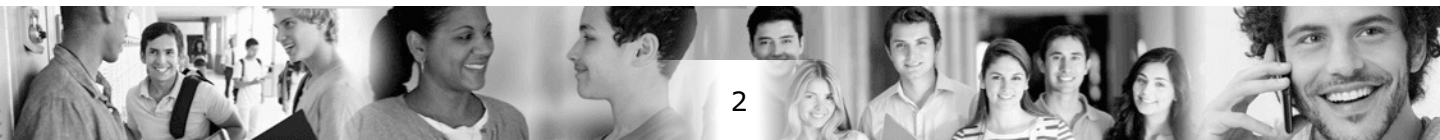
Denise chairs a meeting of the board of BFP Publishing. They need to make a decision before the end of the **fiscal year***.

* A "fiscal year" is any 12-month period a company uses to create a budget, often from April to the next March.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Denise:** Thank you very much, everybody, for attending today's board meeting.
- Mr. Douglas:** My pleasure, as always, Ms. Moore. I just hope the meeting doesn't last three hours like last time.
- Denise:** We'll try to keep things brief in order to expedite the meeting today, Mr. Douglas. The board meeting is called to order at 7:00 p.m. Could we approve the minutes from the last meeting? Are there any amendments?
- Mr. Santos:** Just a small note, my last name is spelled with an S not a Z.
- Denise:** Thank you, Mr. Santos. Any other amendments to the minutes? No? All in favor of approving the meetings from March 25 of last year? Carried. Now for the Chief Executive's Report. Mr. Gardiner, you have the floor.
- Mr. Gardiner:** We have so many plans for significant growth that I feel the most pressing matter is the rental space. I recommend that we sign the lease for the spaces on the 10th and 11th floors in order to remain in the same building.
- Mr. Douglas:** I examined the budgetary provisions for that rental space. It's very expensive. Our operations budget shortfall is very large so I don't think we can afford it at the present time. Denise, what do you think?
- Denise:** The quarterly report shows that we are in a somewhat tight situation. We can count on our regular sales to booksellers, but the school market share is still fragile. Our workbooks are so new that we don't have a significant number of sales in financial literacy publications yet.
- Mr. Santos:** Then, there is the problem of our unsettled lawsuits over plagiarism last year.
- Denise:** Yes, we will be dealing with that for quite some time.
- Mr. Douglas:** Did you deal with the employees who were involved, Denise?
- Denise:** Yes, we have terminated the employment of one editorial assistant, and replaced him with two very bright young graduates.
- Mr. Gardiner:** We could wait another six months so as to solidify our volume of sales before moving office space. Our long-term staffing goals are so ambitious that the move should happen before the end of the fiscal year.
- Denise:** Agreed.





Let's Practice!

The board members conduct their business and give their opinions during the meeting.

Instructions: Proofread the sentence. Cross out the incorrect word. Write the correct word on the line. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. The BFP Publishing Board meeting is calling to orders at 7:00 p.m.

2. Could we approve the notes from the last meeting?

3. Are there any amends?

4. I examined the budget providing for that rental space. It's very expensive.

5. The quarter reporting shows that we are in a somewhat tight situation.

6. We can count on our regular sales to the booksellers, but the school market sharing is still fragile.

7. Then, there is the problem of our unsettled law suits over plagiarism last year.



Let's Practice!

The members of the board talk about the shortfall* in the operations** budget!

*To have a "shortfall" means you have less money than you budgeted (expected) to have.

**"Operations" are the daily activities of a company.

Instructions: Draw a line to match the sentences to complete them correctly. Read the complete sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. BFP has so many plans for growth
2. Our operations budget shortfall is very large
3. Our workbooks are so new
4. Our long-term staffing goals are so ambitious that
5. That issue is so large,

COLUMN B

- a. that we don't have a significant volume of sales in financial literacy publications yet.
- b. that I feel the most pressing matter is the rental space.
- c. we will be dealing with it for quite some time.
- d. so I don't think we can afford it at the present time.
- e. the move should happen before the end of the fiscal year.





Extension Activity

Listen to a meeting and take minutes (notes) of the meeting.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online. Find a short video of a meeting on a topic you are interested in. You can use the keywords "meeting on _____"
- Listen to the meeting. This will inspire you to write the minutes, but you can make up (invent) everything.
- In your minutes, include the following things:
 - The people in attendance
 - The time of the call to order
 - One motion (proposition)
 - Arguments for and against the motion
 - Motion carried or not carried
- Proofread your minutes for correct spelling and punctuation.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I listen to a video of a meeting.

☐ ☐

I write minutes for the meeting.

☐ ☐

I give arguments for and against a proposal.

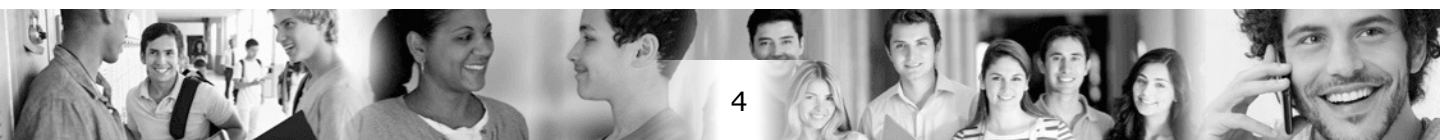
☐ ☐

I say if the motion is carried or not carried.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- board** (noun): the group of people who oversee the operations of a company
e.g. Thank you very much, everybody, for attending today's board meeting.
- to expedite** (verb): to make things go faster
e.g. We'll try to keep things brief in order to expedite the meeting today, Mr. Douglas.
- amendment** (noun): a change to an official document
e.g. Are there any amendments to the minutes?
- carried** (expression): a majority of people have voted in favor of a proposition
e.g. All in favor of approving the meetings from March 25 of last year? Carried.
- budgetary provisions** (noun): the expected costs associated with a project
e.g. I examined the budgetary provisions for that rental space.
- all in favor** (expression): what the chairperson of a meeting says to ask people to vote on a proposition
e.g. All in favor of the motion to change office space?
- lawsuit** (noun): the action of taking a person or company to court (using the legal system) to resolve a dispute
e.g. Then, there is the problem of our unsettled lawsuits over plagiarism last year.
- market share** (noun): the percentage of sales a company obtains in a specific area, compared to the total sales in that area
e.g. We can count on our regular sales to the booksellers, but the school market share is still fragile.
- call to order** (expression): the official start of a meeting
e.g. The BFP Publishing Board meeting is called to order at 7:00 p.m.





Learning Points

Result Clauses

When you want to talk about the results of something, you can use words or phrases like *therefore*, *consequently* or *as a result*. However, you can also use result clauses to make your writing and speaking more dynamic.

You can introduce result clauses using:

so and *so ... that*

So comes at the beginning of the result clause.

For example:

*The three of us were very busy **so we decided to hire more salespeople.***

You also use *so* before adjectives and adverbs followed by a *that*-clause (you can omit *that*).

For example:

*The three of us were **so busy (that) we decided to hire more salespeople.***

Examples:

- *PFB has so many plans for growth that I feel the most pressing matter is the rental space.*
- *Our operations budget shortfall is very large so I don't think we can afford it at the present time.*
- *Our workbooks are so new that we don't have a significant volume of sales in financial literacy publications yet.*





Learning Points

Purpose Clauses

When you want to explain the purpose or reason behind a decision or an action, you can use purpose clauses.

You can introduce a purpose clause with:

in order to ... and *so as to ...*

You use these phrases to:

- emphasize intention

*They arrived early **in order to/so as to** prepare themselves.*

- express a negative purpose

***In order not to be** late, I took a cab.*

You can also use **for** in front of nouns to express purpose.

For example:

They did it **for** the reward.

Examples:

- *Thank you very much, everybody, for attending today's board meeting.*
- *I recommend that we sign the lease for the spaces on the 10th and 11th floors in order to remain in the same building.*
- *We could wait another six months so as to solidify our volume of sales before moving office space.*

